Physical Restraint



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Physical restraints

What it is used for

Physical restraints are specialised devices used in healthcare only when legally permitted and clinically justified to prevent immediate harm. Their use requires authorised, trained staff, the least restrictive approach, and continuous monitoring under approved policy.

How to use

1. Assess the immediate risk and consider de-escalation and less restrictive alternatives first.
2. Obtain required clinical authorisation and follow facility policy and applicable law.
3. Explain the process to the person when safe and appropriate, preserving dignity and privacy.
4. Use only approved restraint equipment and follow the facility's trained application procedure.
5. Ensure the person's breathing, circulation, positioning, and access to urgent help are not compromised.
6. Monitor the person continuously or at the policy-required interval and document observations.
7. Release the restraint as soon as the authorised criteria for continued use no longer apply.
8. Document the reason, authorisation, monitoring, duration, and any adverse effects.

⚠ Safety

- Never use restraints for punishment, convenience, or staff discipline.
- Never apply restraints without required training, authorisation, and clinical oversight.
- Do not obstruct breathing, compress the neck or chest, or leave the person unmonitored.
- Follow emergency procedures immediately if distress, injury, or breathing difficulty occurs.

Care & storage

- Inspect restraint equipment for damage and clean it according to facility policy.
- Store restraints securely and review each use according to clinical governance procedures.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.